

Informative Report Writing: The Great Barrier Reef

Name: _____

Date: _____

Year 6 English — Writing

ACARA v9.0: AC9E6LY06

Learning Intention

I am learning to plan and write an informative report using clear structure, topic-specific vocabulary and factual, objective language.

Success Criteria

- I can structure a report with a general classification, description and conclusion.
- I can use topic-specific vocabulary accurately.
- I can write in an objective, factual tone.

Classify, Describe, Conclude

A good report starts with a general classification (what is it?), then description paragraphs organised by sub-topic, and ends with a summarising conclusion — all in factual, objective language.

Worked Example

Classification: The Great Barrier Reef is the world's largest coral reef system, located off the coast of Queensland, Australia.

Part A — Planning Your Report

Write a general classification sentence introducing the Great Barrier Reef.

List 3 sub-topics you could organise your description paragraphs around (e.g. location, wildlife, threats).

1. _____ 2. _____ 3. _____

Write 2-3 facts you could include under one of your chosen sub-topics.

Write a concluding sentence that summarises the report's key idea.

Part B — Objective, Factual Language

Rewrite this opinion sentence as an objective, factual one: 'The Great Barrier Reef is the most beautiful place on Earth.'

Write a sentence using topic-specific vocabulary (e.g. 'coral bleaching', 'ecosystem', 'biodiversity').

Explain why reports should avoid personal opinions and emotive language.

Write a heading you could use for a sub-topic section about threats to the reef.

Word Bank

classification • ecosystem • biodiversity • coral bleaching • objective • sub-heading • factual

Working Space — Write Your Full Informative Report (Continue on the Back if Needed)

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Answer Key — Part A

A1: Student's own accurate classification sentence — teacher to check factual accuracy and objective tone.

A2: Any 3 reasonable sub-topics (e.g. location, wildlife, threats, size) — teacher to check.

A3: Student's own factual points relevant to their chosen sub-topic — teacher to check accuracy.

A4: Student's own concluding sentence summarising the report — teacher to check it is factual, not opinion-based.

Part B

B1: Any objective rewrite (e.g. "The Great Barrier Reef is the world's largest coral reef system.") — teacher to check opinion words are removed.

B2: Student's own sentence correctly using topic-specific vocabulary — teacher to check.

B3: Reports should present facts clearly and objectively so readers can trust the information, rather than being influenced by the writer's personal feelings.

B4: Any reasonable heading (e.g. "Threats to the Reef", "Challenges Facing the Reef") — teacher to check.

I Can Checklist

☐ I can structure a report with classification, description and conclusion.

☐ I can use topic-specific vocabulary accurately.

☐ I can write in an objective, factual tone.